

Word family: **sort / sorts / sorted / sorting / sorter / sortation**

Base word: sort

Past tense: sorted

Past participle: sorted

Related forms: sorting, sorter, sortation

Useful expressions / extensions: a sort of, sort of, sort by, sort into, sort out

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / discourse-like expression in **sort of**

Your sentence:

> “She is not the **sort** of person who tries to dominate a conversation...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **sort** means **type, kind, or category of person**.

The sentence means that your grandmother is **not the kind of person who tries to control or dominate conversations**.

繁體中文： ** **某一類型、某一種；the sort of person 指「某一類 / 某一種人」 **

中文翻譯：

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to dominate a conversation...”

「她不是那種會試圖主導整個對話的**人 / 類型**.....」

Here:

the sort of person = 某一類型的人 / 那種人

1. **sort = type / kind (種類) — 種類；類型**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “She is not the **sort** of person who tries to dominate a conversation.”

「她不是那種會試圖主導對話的**人 / 類型**。」

Practice 2

> “What **sort** of music do you like?”

「你喜歡甚麼**類型**的音樂？」

Practice 3

> “That is exactly the **sort** of book I enjoy.”

「那正是我喜歡的那**類書**。」

sort = 按共同特徵、性質或用途分成的一種類型

2. **sort of + noun** (某一類 / 某種) — 某種 ; 某類

Practice 4

> “What **sort of** work does she do?”

「她做哪一**類**工作？」

Practice 5

> “This is a different **sort of** problem.”

「這是另一**類**問題。」

sort of + noun = 某一類型的.....

This is very close to:

> kind of

> type of

3. **all sorts of + plural noun** (各種各樣) — 各種 ; 各式各樣

A very common expression.

Practice 6

> “She knows **all sorts of** people.”

「她認識**各種各樣**的人。」

Practice 7

> “The shop sells **all sorts of** fruit.”

「這間店出售**各式各樣的水果**。」

all sorts of = 很多不同種類的

4. **sorts of + noun** (不同種類) — 各種 ; 不同種類

Practice 8

> “There are many different **sorts of** tea.”

「有很多不同**種類**的茶。」

Practice 9

> “The museum displays several **sorts of** traditional tools.”

「博物館展示了幾種不同**類型**的傳統工具。」

sorts of = 不同種類 / 類型的

5. **sort = kind of person** (某類人) — 類型 ; 某種人

A particularly common use with people.

Practice 10

> “He is the **sort** of person who always arrives early.”

「他是那種總是提早到達的**人**。」

Practice 11

> “She is not my **sort** of person.”

「她不是我喜歡的那**類型**的人。」

sort of person = 具有某種典型性格、習慣或行為的人

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

6. **my sort / your sort (某人喜歡的類型) — 喜歡的類型**

Practice 12

> “He is not really my **sort**.”

「他不太是我喜歡的**類型**。」

Practice 13

> “Is that your **sort** of film?”

「那是你喜歡的那**類電影**嗎？」

someone's sort = 符合某人口味、偏好或喜好的類型

This is informal.

7. **sort = category/classification (分類) — 類別；種類**

Practice 14

> “The items are divided into several **sorts**.”

「這些物品被分成幾個**類別**。」

Practice 15

> “Each **sort** has different characteristics.”

「每個**類別**都有不同特徵。」

sort = 根據共同特徵形成的分類單位

8. **sort — verb = arrange into categories (分類) — 分類；整理**

A major separate verb meaning.

Practice 16

> “Please **sort** the documents by date.”

「請按日期把文件**分類整理**。」

Practice 17

> “She **sorted** the clothes into different piles.”

「她把衣服**分類**成幾堆。」

sort = 按某種規則、特徵或類別把東西分組排列

9. **sort by + feature** (按.....分類) — 按.....排序 / 分類

Practice 18

> “You can **sort by** price.”

「你可以按價格**排序**。」

Practice 19

> “The files are **sorted by** name.”

「檔案按名稱**排序**。」

sort by + criterion = 根據某項標準把資料或物件排列 / 分類

Common in:

- * software
- * spreadsheets
- * databases
- * shopping websites

10. **sort into + groups/categories** (分成.....) — 分類成 ; 歸入

Practice 20

> “The books were **sorted into** three groups.”

「書本被**分成三類**。」

Practice 21

> “Please **sort** the cards **into** colours.”

「請按顏色把卡片**分類**。」

sort into = 把東西分配到不同類別 / 組別中

11. **sort** = arrange in order (排序) — 排序 ; 排列

This is especially common in computing/data.

Practice 22

> “The list is **sorted** alphabetically.”

「這個清單按字母順序**排列**。」

Practice 23

> “Click here to **sort** the results from lowest to highest.”

「按這裡把結果由低至高**排序**。」

sort = 按特定順序重新排列資料或項目

This is related to classification but focuses on **ordering**.

12. **sort out** = organize / deal with (處理 ; 整理) — 處理 ; 解決 ; 整理好

A highly common phrasal extension.

Practice 24

> “I need to **sort out** my schedule.”

「我需要把自己的時間表**整理好**。」

Practice 25

> “We need to **sort out** this problem.”

「我們需要**處理 / 解決**這個問題。」

sort out = 把混亂、問題或安排整理清楚並處理好

Under the no-phrasal-verbs-by-default rule, this is secondary, but it is extremely common.

13. **sort out** + disagreement/problem (解決爭議 / 問題) — 解決 ; 處理

Practice 26

> “They met to **sort out** their disagreement.”

「他們見面來**解決彼此的分歧**。」

Practice 27

> “She helped us **sort out** the issue.”

「她幫助我們**處理好這個問題**。」

sort out = 經過討論或處理，使問題、衝突或混亂得到解決

14. **sort of** = somewhat / rather (有點 ; 有幾分) — 有點 ; 算是

This is a major discourse-like use.

Practice 28

> “I’m **sort of** tired.”

「我**有點**累。」

Practice 29

> “It was **sort of** strange.”

「那件事**有點**奇怪。」

****sort of = 表示程度不完全、語氣較含糊；有點 / 某程度上****

This no longer means literal “type of.”

15. ****sort of = approximately / not exactly (大概；算是) — 大概；算是****

Practice 30

> “She is ****sort of**** the leader of the group.”

「她****算是****這個小組的領導者。」

Practice 31

> “It’s ****sort of**** a tradition now.”

「現在這****算是一種傳統****了。」

****sort of = 表示某種描述大致成立，但不是完全精確****

16. ****a sort of + noun (某種像.....的東西) — 一種；有點像.....****

Practice 32

> “It was ****a sort of**** apology.”

「那****算是一種道歉****。」

Practice 33

> “The room has ****a sort of**** calm atmosphere.”

「房間有****一種****平靜的氣氛。」

****a sort of = 表示某物大致可歸為某類，但說話者不想 / 不能完全精確分類****

17. ****of a sort (某種程度的；勉強算) — 某種；勉強算是****

A useful slightly formal/idiomatic expression.

Practice 34

> “They reached an agreement **of a sort**.”

「他們達成了一個**勉強算是協議的東西**。」

Practice 35

> “It was a victory **of a sort**.”

「那**勉強也算是一種勝利**。」

of a sort = 某種程度上可以這樣稱呼，但並非典型或令人完全滿意的例子

18. **nothing of the sort** — 完全不是那回事

A common fixed expression.

Practice 36

> “I said **nothing of the sort**.”

「我**完全沒有說過那種話**。」

Practice 37

> “He accused me of being angry, but I felt **nothing of the sort**.”

「他說我生氣了，但我**完全沒有那回事**。」

nothing of the sort = 完全不是所說的那種情況 / 事情

19. **something of the sort** — 類似的東西 / 情況

Practice 38

> “We need a table or **something of the sort**.”

「我們需要一張桌子，或者**類似的東西**。」

Practice 39

> “I expected an apology or **something of the sort**.”

「我本來以為會有道歉或者**類似的表示**。」

something of the sort = 與剛才提到的事物或類型大致相似的東西

20. **that sort of thing** — 那一類事情；諸如此類

Practice 40

> “She enjoys gardening, cooking, and **that sort of thing**.”

「她喜歡園藝、煮飯，還有**諸如此類的活動**。」

Practice 41

> “I’m not very interested in gossip and **that sort of thing**.”

「我對八卦和**那一類事情**不太有興趣。」

that sort of thing = 與前面例子屬於同一大類的事情；諸如此類

21. **some sort of + noun** (某種 / 某類) — 某種；某一類

Practice 42

> “There must be **some sort of** mistake.”

「一定有**某種錯誤**。」

Practice 43

> “We need **some sort of** system.”

「我們需要**某種制度 / 系統**。」

some sort of = 某一種，但說話者沒有或不需要指出確切類型

22. **sort yourself out** (整理好自己 / 解決自己的問題) — 調整好；處理好

A common informal phrasal use.

Practice 44

> “I need a few days to **sort myself out**.”

「我需要幾天時間把自己**調整好 / 理清狀況**。」

Practice 45

> “He needs to **sort himself out** before making a decision.”

「他需要先把自己的狀況**理清 / 處理好**，再作決定。」

sort yourself out = 把自己的情緒、生活、問題或安排重新整理好

Informal.

23. **sorted = organized / dealt with (英式口語) — 搞定了 ; 處理好了**

A useful lexicalized adjective, especially British English.

Practice 46

> “Everything is **sorted**.”

「所有事情都**搞定了 / 處理好了**。」

Practice 47

> “Don’t worry—the booking is **sorted**.”

「別擔心，預訂已經**處理好了**。」

sorted = 問題、安排或工作已經處理妥當

Register: informal, especially British English.

24. **sorting = act/process of organizing/classifying (分類 / 排序) — 分類 ; 整理 ; 排序**

Practice 48

> “The **sorting** of the files took several hours.”

「文件的**分類整理**花了幾個小時。」

Practice 49

> “Automated **sorting** saves time.”

「自動**分類 / 排序**可以節省時間。」

sorting = 按類別、特徵或次序整理東西的過程

25. **sorter** = person/machine that sorts (分類者 / 分類機) — 分揀員；分類器

Practice 50

> “The parcels pass through an automatic **sorter**.”

「包裹會經過一部自動**分類機 / 分揀設備**。」

Practice 51

> “She worked as a mail **sorter**.”

「她曾任郵件**分揀員**。」

sorter = 負責將物品分類的人或機器

26. **sortation** = automated sorting process (專業) — 分揀；分類作業

A technical logistics term.

Practice 52

> “The warehouse uses an automated **sortation** system.”

「倉庫使用自動**分揀系統**。」

Practice 53

> “Parcel **sortation** happens overnight.”

「包裹**分揀作業**在夜間進行。」

****sortation = 在物流、郵件或倉儲系統中把大量物品自動 / 系統化分類的過程****

This is specialized and less important for ordinary learners than ****sorting****.

Important distinction: **sort vs kind**

These are very close.

**sort**

> “What sort of person is she?”

**kind**

> “What kind of person is she?”

Both mean:

> 「她是哪一類型的人？」

****Kind**** is extremely common in both British and American English.

****Sort**** is also common, especially in British English.

In many ordinary contexts they are interchangeable.

Important distinction: **sort vs type**

**sort / kind**

often sound conversational and flexible.

**type**

can sound slightly more systematic or classificatory.

> “a type of software”

> “a sort of person”

All can overlap, but **type** often feels more formal/technical.

Important distinction: sort = type vs sort = arrange

This is the major lexical contrast.

Noun:

> “What sort of person is she?”

= 她是哪一類人？

Verb:

> “Sort the documents.”

= 把文件分類。

Same spelling, different grammatical function and concept.

Important distinction: sort of + noun vs sort of + adjective

This is crucial.

sort of + noun

> “this sort of person”

= 這一類人

Here **sort** means **type**.

sort of + adjective

> “sort of tired”

= 有點累

Here **sort of** means **somewhat**.

So:

> **sort of person**

> ≠

> **sort of tired**

Different grammatical functions and meanings.

Important distinction: **a sort of vs sort of**

a sort of + noun

usually means:

> a kind/type of something

or something approximately resembling that category.

> “a sort of machine”

sort of + adjective/verb

often means:

> somewhat / approximately.

> “I sort of understand.”

= 我大概明白。

Learners should notice the article **a**.

Important distinction: **sort of vs somewhat**

Both can mean 「有點 / 某程度上」.

sort of

more conversational and informal.

> “I’m sort of worried.”

somewhat

more neutral/formal.

> “I’m somewhat concerned.”

So register differs.

Important distinction: **sort of vs kind of**

For the “somewhat” meaning:

> “I’m sort of tired.”

> “I’m kind of tired.”

Both are very common.

Kind of is especially common in American conversational English; **sort of** is very common in British English and also widely understood elsewhere.

Important distinction: **sort vs category**

sort

is ordinary learner-friendly vocabulary.

category

is more formal/systematic and usually refers to an explicitly defined classification.

> “This product belongs to a different category.”

So not every everyday **sort** needs the more formal word **category**.

Important distinction: **sort by vs sort into**

sort by + criterion

= use a standard to arrange/classify

> “sort by date”

= 按日期排序

sort into + groups

= put things into resulting categories

> “sort into three groups”

= 分成三組

This is a very useful grammar distinction.

Important distinction: **sort vs organize**

sort

focuses on:

> grouping or ordering items according to a rule.

organize

is broader:

> arrange things so they are structured, manageable, or efficient.

You can organize a meeting, but normally not:

> sort a meeting

unless you mean informally **sort out the meeting arrangements**.

Important distinction: **sort vs classify**

sort

is common everyday vocabulary and can mean physically arranging items.

classify

is more formal and focuses on assigning items to conceptual categories.

> “Scientists classify species.”

> “I sorted the laundry.”

The underlying idea overlaps, but register and context differ.

Important distinction: **sort out** vs **solve**

solve

focuses on finding the answer to a problem.

sort out

is broader and more conversational:

- * solve a problem
- * organize a situation
- * settle a disagreement
- * fix arrangements

> “We’ll sort it out.”

= 我們會把事情處理好。

Family-extension note

Following the reference curation style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **sort** family:

- * **sort — type/kind** = 種類 / 類型
- * **sort of person** = 某一類型的人
- * **sort of + noun** = 某種類型的……
- * **all sorts of** = 各式各樣的
- * **my/your sort** = 符合某人喜好的類型
- * **sort — classify** = 分類
- * **sort by** = 按某標準排序 / 分類
- * **sort into** = 分成不同類別
- * **sort — order** = 排序
- * **sort out** = 整理好 / 解決 / 處理
- * **sort of — somewhat** = 有點 / 某程度上

* **a sort of** = 一種 / 算是一種
 * **of a sort** = 勉強算某種
 * **nothing of the sort** = 完全不是那回事
 * **something of the sort** = 類似的東西
 * **that sort of thing** = 諸如此類
 * **some sort of** = 某種
 * **sorted — informal** = 搞定 / 處理妥當
 * **sorting** = 分類 / 排序過程
 * **sorter** = 分揀員 / 分類器
 * **sortation** = 分揀作業 (物流 / 技術)

As in the reference examples, these include core noun/verb meanings, grammatical constructions, discourse-like uses, phrasal extensions, and technical family members. They should be included for learning value while keeping the “type” and “arrange” concepts clearly distinct.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sort — type/kind	按共同特徵、性質或用途所形成的一種類型
sort of person	具有某種典型性格、習慣或行為的一類人
sort of + noun	某一種類型的.....
all sorts of	很多不同種類 / 類型的
my/your sort	符合某人喜好、口味或偏好的類型
sort — category	根據共同特徵形成的分類單位
sort — verb: classify	按某種規則、特徵或類別把東西分組
sort by	根據某項標準把資料或物件排列 / 分類
sort into	把物品分配到不同組別 / 類別中
sort — order	按特定順序重新排列資料或項目
sort out — organize	把混亂的安排、資料或事情整理清楚
sort out — solve	經處理後使問題、衝突或困難得到解決
sort of — somewhat	表示程度並不完全；有點 / 某程度上
sort of — approximately	表示某個描述大致成立但不是完全精確
a sort of	某種 / 大致可視為某類的東西
of a sort	勉強可算某種類型，但並非典型或完全理想
nothing of the sort	完全不是剛才所說的那種事情 / 情況
something of the sort	與剛才提到的事物大致相似的東西
that sort of thing	與前述例子同類的其他事情；諸如此類
some sort of	某一種類型，但沒有指出確切種類
sorted — informal	問題、安排或工作已經處理妥當
sorting	按類別、特徵或次序整理東西的過程
sorter	負責將物品分類的人或設備
sortation	物流 / 倉儲中系統化或自動進行的分揀過程

For your original sentence

> “She is not the **sort** of person who tries to dominate a conversation...”

The exact meaning is:

sort = 具有某種共同性格或行為特徵的一種類型

Therefore:

> **the sort of person who...**

= **「那種會.....的人 / 那一類型的人」**

So:

> “She is not the sort of person who tries to dominate a conversation.”

= **「她不是那種會試圖主導整個對話的人。」**

The key polysemy contrast is:

> **sort — noun**

> = 種類 / 類型

versus:

> **sort — verb**

> = 分類 / 排序

and then the very common grammaticalized expression:

> **sort of tired**

> = 有點累

So **sort** is especially valuable because the same form can mean **a category**, **the act of organizing into categories**, or—in **sort of**—a conversational marker meaning **somewhat / approximately**.